

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1066

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Freed-Hardeman University Head Coaches Abby Stutts and Drew Stutts.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pay tribute to the excellent coaches who have led their teams to unprecedented success in athletic competition; and

WHEREAS, Head Coaches Abby Stutts and Drew Stutts, siblings hailing from Florence, Alabama, have led the Freed-Hardeman University (FHU) Lions and Lady Lions to Mid-South Conference (MSC) Tournament titles and into the NAIA National Tournaments, delivering dominant seasons and cultivating a culture of discipline, preparation, belief, and overall success; and

WHEREAS, the Freed-Hardeman Lions finished conference play undefeated for the first time in school history with a 12-0 record, completed the regular season 27-1, and secured their fourth consecutive MSC Tournament title with a 72-64 win over Bethel; the Lady Lions finished the season 27-3 and defeated the Bethel Wildcats 64-56 to win the MSC Tournament; and

WHEREAS, the Lions completed a twenty-six-game winning streak, and the Lady Lions a five-game winning streak, for a combined thirty-one games; and

WHEREAS, together, the Stutts siblings have compiled a 223-61 record throughout their basketball careers, reflecting their lifelong love for the game, which was instilled in them in a home where discipline, faith, and sports were foundational; and

WHEREAS, Drew Stutts, who is currently in his seventh year as head coach, began his coaching career at Mars Hill Bible School and later coached at Chester County High School before officially stepping into an assistant role at FHU; and

WHEREAS, Abby Stutts joined the FHU staff as an assistant in 2020 and has served as head coach of the Lady Lions for the past two years; and

WHEREAS, Abby Stutts and Drew Stutts have distinguished themselves as great basketball coaches, tacticians, and motivators of young men and women, and they should be appropriately recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Freed-Hardeman University Head Coaches Abby Stutts and Drew Stutts, salute their outstanding careers on the basketball court, and extend to them our best wishes for much continued success on the field of play and in life.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.